

The present simple and present continuous are used in different situations. There are different ways to form questions and negatives with these tenses.

See also:

Present simple **1** Present continuous **4**

Forming questions **34** Infinitives and participles **51**

Giorgio **plays** golf every weekend.

This is a repeated action.



Robert **lives** in London.

This is a continuing state.



Julia **is playing** lots of golf these days.

This is a repeated action happening around the present moment.



At the moment, Robert **is watching** TV.

This is an ongoing action in the present moment.



5.3 PRESENT TENSE NEGATIVES

Present simple negatives with "be" are formed differently from other verbs.

I am **not** French.

"Not" is added after the form of "be."

I **do not** speak French.

"Do not" or "does not" is added between the subject and main verb.

Present continuous negatives are always formed in the same way.

It is **not** raining.

"Not" is added after the form of "be."

QUESTION

The verb always goes in its base form in questions.

Does he **finish** work on time? ✓

Does he **finishes** work on time? ✗

"-s" or "-es" are not added to the main verb when asking a question.

NEGATIVE

The base form is used in the negative.

He does not **work** weekends. ✓

He does not **works** weekends. ✗

"-s" or "-es" are not added to the main verb in negative sentences.